

CAN ÇELEBI

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CURRENT POSITION

Postdoctoral Researcher

Vienna Center for Experimental Economics (VCEE), University of Vienna

12/2024 – Present

Vienna, AT

PREVIOUS POSITION

Researcher¹

Max Planck Institute for Intelligent Systems

03/2021 – 09/2023

Tübingen, DE

EDUCATION

University of Mannheim

Ph.D. in Economics (Magna Cum laude)

2014 – 2024

Mannheim, DE

Yale University

Visiting Scholar

2015 – 2016

New Haven, US

University of Nottingham

Master of Science in Economics (with Distinction)

2012 – 2013

Nottingham, UK

Middlebury College

Bachelor of Arts in Economics

2006 – 2010

Middlebury, US

Istanbul University

Bachelor of Science in Economics

2005 – 2011

Istanbul, TR

PUBLICATIONS

Much Ado about Prompting: LLM Classification of Text Messages from Experiments

PLOS ONE, 2026.

joint with Stefan P. Penczynski

Navigating AI Convergence in Human-Artificial Intelligence Teams: A Signaling Theory Approach

Journal of Organizational Behavior, 2025.

joint with Andria Smith, Huner Wagoner, Ksenia Keplinger

From Crypto to NFTs: Identifying the New Wave of Digital Investors

International Review of Financial Analysis, 2025.

joint with Stefano Balietti, David T. Lucas

Team communication and individuals' reasoning and decisions

Encyclopedia of Experimental Social Science, Elgar Encyclopedias in the Social Sciences, 2025.

joint with Stefan P. Penczynski

¹Two consecutive 9-month half-time internships, followed by a 1-year full-time research role.

WORKING PAPERS

Strategic Thinking in Jury Decisions: An Experimental Study

R&R in JEBO

joint with Stefan P. Penczynski

Mission Possible: The Collection of High-Quality Data

Under peer review

joint with Christine Exley, Sören Harrs, Hannu Kivimaki, Marta Serra-Garcia, Jeffrey Yusof

Meme Money, Real People: Decoding the Crypto Memecoin Crowd

R&R in IRFA

joint with Stefano Ballestti, David T. Lucas, Luca Pennella

WORK IN PROGRESS

Beyond Accuracy: Stability Metrics for Large Language Model Classifiers

joint with Stefan P. Penczynski

Monte Carlo versus Log-Probability Inference in LLM-based Decision Simulations

joint with Pawel Niszczoła

Expert, crowd and machine: comparing LLM and human classification distributions of strategic thinking

joint with Stefan P. Penczynski

Clarifying Without Bias: Chatbots as Research-Assistants in Online and Lab Experiments

joint with Christian Koch, Stefan P. Penczynski

Regret in the Loop: Large Language Models as Risk Nudges in Investment Tasks

joint with Pawel Niszczoła

Cross-Country Evidence on Information Evaluation Competence: Chatbot vs Video Intervention

joint with Christian Koch, Stefan P. Penczynski

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Referee: *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization, PLOS One, Science Advances, Frontiers in Psychology*

Invited Speaker / Workshop Organizer

Invited Speaker - LLM Text Classification

Institute of Economics and Law, University of Stuttgart, DE

May 2026

Invited Speaker - LLM Text Classification

Department of Economics and Business, Central European University, AT

May 2026

Invited Speaker - Gotta Catch'Em All: Web Agents in Online Surveys

Vienna Behavioural Circle, AT

April 2026

Workshop Organizer - LLM Text Classification

School of Economics, University of East Anglia, UK

January 2025

Invited Speaker - Large Language Models: Prompting Techniques and Their Potential to Conduct Complex Research Tasks in Social Sciences

SKN HAI and HAI Laboratory, Poznan University of Economics and Business, PL

June 2024

WORKSHOPS AND PRESENTATIONS

Presenter

Clarifying Without Bias: Chatbots as Research-Assistant Replacements in Online and Lab Experiments

IT for Science Forum, University of Vienna, AT

November 2025

Presenter

Expert, crowd and machine: comparing LLM and human classification distributions of strategic thinking

Brown Bag Seminar, University of Vienna, AT

October 2025

Panel Speaker

Behavioral Game Theory Workshop 2025, University of East Anglia, UK

July 2025

Presenter

Expert, crowd and machine: comparing LLM and human classification distributions of strategic thinking

Behavioral Game Theory Workshop 2025, University of East Anglia, UK

July 2025

Presenter

Using Large Language Models for Text Classification in Experimental Economics

Text as Data in Behavioral Economics Workshop, University of Potsdam, DE

June 2025

Presenter

Strategic thinking in jury decisions: an experimental study

HeiKaMaX, KIT Karlsruhe, DE

June 2018

RESEARCH AFFILIATIONS

Co-founder

State of Crypto

An international research collaborative studying the digital economy and web3.

2022 - Present

External Affiliate

CBESS, University of East Anglia

2024 - Present

GRANTS

Azure AI Services research grant (€2,500), ZID, University of Vienna

2026 – 2027

Graf Hardegg grant (€3,600), Heinrich Graf Hardegg Foundation

2025 – 2027

Seed research grant (€2,000), Department of Economics, University of Vienna

2025 – 2027

Azure AI Services research grant (€2,000), ZID, University of Vienna

2025 – 2026

SCHOLARSHIPS

DAAD Scholarship, <i>Yale University</i>	2016 – 2017
Fontana Fellowship for Ph.D. studies, <i>University of Mannheim</i>	2015 – 2016
Turkish Student Scholarship, <i>University of Nottingham</i>	2012 – 2013
International Student Scholarship, <i>Middlebury College</i>	2006 – 2010

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Fellow - Advanced Impact Evaluation (Master level), <i>Central European University</i>	2026
Teaching Fellow - Impact Evaluation: Policy Applications with R (Master level), <i>Central European University</i>	2026
Teaching Assistant - Advanced Microeconomics (PhD level), <i>University of Mannheim</i>	2019
Teaching Assistant - Advanced Mathematics (PhD level), <i>University of Mannheim</i>	2019
Teaching Assistant - Advanced Microeconomics (PhD level), <i>University of Mannheim</i>	2018
Teaching Assistant - Advanced Mathematics (PhD level), <i>University of Mannheim</i>	2018
Research Assistant for Dr. Stefan Penczynski, <i>University of Mannheim</i>	2017
Teaching Assistant - Advanced Microeconomics (Masters level), <i>University of Mannheim</i>	2017
Teaching Assistant - Intro to Microeconomics (Undergraduate level), <i>Yale University</i>	2016
Tutor - Intro and Intermediate Microeconomics (Undergraduate level), <i>Middlebury College</i>	2007 – 2010
Teaching Assistant - Intermediate Microeconomics (Undergraduate level), <i>Middlebury College</i>	2007 – 2009
Teaching Assistant - Intro to Microeconomics (Undergraduate level), <i>Middlebury College</i>	2007 – 2009

SKILLS

Computer:	R, z-Tree, oTree, nodeGame, JavaScript, Python
Languages:	Turkish (Native), English (Fluent), French (Fluent, rusty), German (Beginner/Intermediate)